GUEST COLUMN | K. RADHAKRISHNAN





"A SPECIFIC GAIN FROM IIM-B WERE THE LESSONS IN INSTITUTION-BUILDING"

STUDENTS AT THE PREMIER INSTITUTE LEARN HOW TO LOOK AT ANY SITUATION IN A SYSTEMATIC MANNER, AND WITH A LONG-TIME HORIZON

I **joined the first batch of the Indian Institute of Management–Bangalore** (IIM-B) that was founded in 1973. As a young avionics engineer with the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), I was then working at the Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC) in Thumba. I was eager to pursue higher studies in management, and IIM-B, naturally, came into my radar. Its USP at that time was the resolve to create a professional management cadre for the Indian public sector, and that meant instilling a society/service-centric value system, besides the skillsets for a typical business executive.

A doyen of management education, Professor N. S. Ramaswamy was our founding director. Within a year, he brought together 50 brilliant faculty members from India and abroad, and elegantly set up a temporary campus in and around a heritage building at Bengaluru's Langford Garden. We, the first batch of 55 engineers, mostly with working experience varying from two to five years, were enrolled by September 1974.

At VSSC, I was used to a tenacious routine of long deliberations and stringent schedules—I would often report at 6 am and return at 10.30 pm. At IIM-B, the academic pressure went far beyond that. By the end of the second term, we had proved that we could remain alert even after 18–19 hours of lectures, group discussions, seminars, projects, take-home assignments and fortnightly tests. This premier batch has had an excellent track record—four of us have received the "distinguished alumni award" from IIM-B, including Arun Balakrishnan (former CMD of Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd), M.S. Zaheed, (former CMD of HMT Ltd) and Abhishek Mukherjee (former CEO of Compaq India, and founder of Magnasoft).

TOP 10 GOVERNMENT B-SCHOOLS WITH BEST VALUE FOR MONEY

ROI RANK	NAME OF THE INSTITUTE	CITY	ROI
1	DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE, FACULTY OF COMMERCE AND BUSINESS, DELHI SCHOOL OF ECONOMICS, UNIVERSITY OF DELHI	New Delhi	41.43
2	FACULTY OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES, UNIVERSITY OF DELHI	New Delhi	16.67
3	FACULTY OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES & RESEARCH, ALIGARH MUSLIM UNIVERSITY	Aligarh	14.42
4	FACULTY OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES, MS UNIVERSITY OF BARODA	Vadodara	13.98
5	SYDENHAM INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES, RESEARCH AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP EDUCATION	Mumbai	9.66
6	DEPARTMENT OF INDUSTRIAL AND MANAGEMENT ENGINEERING, IIT KANPUR	Kanpur	5.64
7	JAMNALAL BAJAJ INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES	Mumbai	4.67
8	POSTGRADUATE DEPARTMENT OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT, SARDAR PATEL UNIVERSITY	Vallabh Vidyanagar Anand	4.50
9	THE BUSINESS SCHOOL, UNIVERSITY OF JAMMU	Jammu	4.43
10	DEPARTMENT OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES, PONDICHERRY UNIVERSITY	Puducherry	4.13

Note: ROI (return on investment) is calculated by dividing average domestic annual salary with fees for the entire course